

The Divine Liturgy

of Saint John Chrysostom

Transcribed from a parish service notebook, in order, for personal study and for following along during the Liturgy.

How to read this. Speaker cues are given in small capitals. Directions for what is happening in the altar and around the church are set in italics. Shaded boxes mark the parts of the Liturgy that change from day to day — these are not printed in the service book and must be taken from the parish bulletin or the Archdiocese's Online Liturgical Guide (antiochian.org/liturgicday).

The long priestly prayers said quietly in the altar are given by their opening words, followed by the concluding exclamation that is said aloud and answered by the choir. These are the prayers the congregation does not hear, so the abbreviation does not affect following the service.

THE BEGINNING

PRIEST: O heavenly King, Comforter, the Spirit of truth, who art everywhere present and fillest all things, the Treasury of good things and Giver of life: Come and abide in us, and cleanse us from every stain, and save our souls, O good One.

Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will among men. (*thrice*)

O Lord, thou shalt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare thy praise. (*twice*)

O Lord, Lord, open to us the door of Thy mercy.

DEACON: It is time for the Lord to act. Bless, holy master.

PRIEST: Blessed is our God, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen. Pray for me, holy master.

PRIEST: The Lord direct thy steps unto every good work.

DEACON: Remember me, holy master.

PRIEST: The Lord God remember thee in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen.

The deacon exits the sanctuary and, standing at his place on the solea, says aloud:

Bless, master.

The priest kisses the gospel book, lifts and lowers it, making with it the sign of the cross over the antimimension and saying:

PRIEST: Blessed is the kingdom of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

THE LITANY OF PEACE

DEACON: In peace, let us pray to the Lord.

*The choir responds **Lord, have mercy** to each petition.*

For the peace from above and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

For this holy house and those who with faith, reverence and fear of God enter therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For our father and metropolitan, *N.*, (our bishop, *N.*) the honorable presbytery, the diaconate in Christ, all the clergy and the people, let us pray to the Lord.

For our country, its president (*or appropriate head of state*), civil authorities and armed forces, let us pray to the Lord.

For this city and every city and countryside and the faithful who dwell therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For healthful seasons, abundance of the fruits of the earth and peaceful times, let us pray to the Lord.

For travelers by sea, by land and by air, the sick, the suffering, the captive, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

For our deliverance from all tribulation, wrath, danger and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

THE PRAYER OF THE FIRST ANTIPHON

PRIEST: O Lord our God, whose might is beyond compare, whose glory is incomprehensible, whose mercy is boundless and whose love toward mankind is ineffable ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: For unto thee are due all glory, honor and worship, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

THE FIRST ANTIPHON

Through the intercessions of the Theotokos, O Saviour, save us.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Through the intercessions of the Theotokos, O Saviour, save us.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Through the intercessions of the Theotokos, O Saviour, save us.

THE LITTLE LITANY

DEACON: Again and again, in peace, let us pray to the Lord.

*The choir responds **Lord, have mercy** to each petition.*

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

THE PRAYER OF THE SECOND ANTIPHON

PRIEST: O Lord our God, save thy people, and bless thine inheritance; preserve the fullness of thy Church, sanctify those who love the beauty of thy house ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: For thine is the might, and thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

THE SECOND ANTIPHON

Save us, O Son of God, who art risen from the dead, who sing to thee: Alleluia. (*twice*)

On weekdays: "...who art wondrous in the saints."

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Save us, O Son of God, who art risen from the dead, who sing to thee: Alleluia.

Both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Only-begotten Son and Word of God, who art immortal, who for our salvation deigned to be incarnate of the holy Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary and without change became man and wast crucified, O Christ our God, and trampled down death by death, who art one of the Holy Trinity, glorified together with the Father and the Holy Spirit: save us.

THE LITTLE LITANY

DEACON: Again and again, in peace, let us pray to the Lord.

The choir responds Lord, have mercy to each petition.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

THE PRAYER OF THE THIRD ANTIPHON

PRIEST: O thou who hast granted us to make these common supplications in one accord and dost promise that when two or three are gathered together in thy name thou wilt grant their requests ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: For thou art a good God and lovest mankind, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

THE ENTRANCE

While the choir chants the appropriate hymn of the day, the priest and deacon make the little entrance, saying as they go:

» **THIRD ANTIPHON / HYMN OF THE DAY — see bulletin**

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord.

PRIEST: O Master, Lord our God, who hast appointed in heaven orders and hosts of angels and archangels for the service of thy glory: Cause that with our entrance there may be an entrance of holy angels serving with us and glorifying thy goodness. For unto thee are due all glory, honor and worship, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen.

Standing on the solea, the deacon says to the priest:

DEACON: Bless, master, the holy entrance.

The priest blesses toward the east, saying:

PRIEST: Blessed is the entrance of thy holy ones, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen.

The deacon elevates the gospel book and says:

DEACON: Wisdom. Stand upright.

The clergy, alone or with the choir, chant the appointed eisodikon as they enter the sanctuary.

THE EISODIKON

Come, let us worship and fall down before Christ. Save us, O Son of God...

(Sundays) ...who art risen from the dead, who sing unto thee: Alleluia.

(Weekdays) ...who art wondrous in the saints, who sing unto thee: Alleluia.

Then, the choir chants the appointed apolytikia, while the priest says the prayer of the thrice-holy hymn.

» **APOLYTIKIA / TROPARIA OF THE DAY — see bulletin**

THE PRAYER OF THE THRICE-HOLY HYMN

PRIEST: O holy God, who retest among the holy ones, who art hymned by the seraphim with the thrice-holy cry and glorified by the cherubim and worshipped by every heavenly power ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

The clergy then chant the appointed kontakion, the choir chanting the concluding phrase.

» **KONTAKION — see bulletin**

The deacon then stands in the holy doors and says:

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord.

CHOIR: Lord, have mercy.

PRIEST: For holy art thou, O our God, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever...

DEACON: ...and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

The choir chants the thrice-holy hymn or its appointed replacement, while the priest and deacon say the same.

THE THRICE-HOLY HYMN

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us. (*thrice*)

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

Holy Immortal: have mercy on us.

DEACON: With strength.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal: have mercy on us.

» **REPLACEMENT FOR THE THRICE-HOLY HYMN — on certain feasts; see bulletin**

The deacon then says to the priest:

DEACON: Command, master.

The priest and deacon proceed to the high place, as the priest says the following:

PRIEST: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

The deacon then points to the throne and says the following to the priest:

DEACON: Bless, master, the throne on high.

PRIEST: Blessed art thou on the throne of the glory of thy kingdom, who art enthroned upon the cherubim, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen.

THE EPISTLE

The reader stands on the solea, facing east. After the thrice-holy hymn, the deacon turns to face the reader and says:

DEACON: Let us attend.

READER: (*says the prokeimenon of the epistle*)

» **PROKEIMENON — see bulletin**

DEACON: Wisdom.

READER: (*says the title of the epistle*)

DEACON: Let us attend.

The reader faces west and chants the appointed epistle. During this time, the deacon censens around the holy table. At the conclusion of the epistle, the reader faces east as the priest blesses him, saying:

» **THE EPISTLE — see bulletin**

PRIEST: Peace be to thee that readeest.

CHOIR: Alleluia. (*thrice*)

» **ALLELUIA VERSES — see bulletin**

THE GOSPEL

As the epistle is being chanted, the deacon says to the priest:

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord. Lord, have mercy.

Then the priest says the prayer before the gospel:

PRIEST: Illumine our hearts, O Master who lovest mankind, with the pure light of thy divine knowledge, and open the eyes of our mind to the understanding of thy gospel teachings; implant in us also the fear of thy blessed commandments that, trampling down all carnal desires, we may enter upon a spiritual manner of living, both thinking and doing such things as are well-pleasing unto thee. For thou art the Illumination of our souls and bodies, O Christ our God, and unto thee we ascribe glory, together with thine unoriginate Father and thine all-holy, good and life-giving Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

The deacon bows before the priest and says:

DEACON: Bless, master, him that proclaimeth the good tidings of the holy, glorious apostle and evangelist *N*.

The priest blesses the deacon, saying:

PRIEST: May God, through the prayers of the holy, glorious apostle and evangelist *N*., enable thee to proclaim the good tidings with great power, to the fulfillment of the gospel of his beloved Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

DEACON: Amen. Amen. Amen. Let it be to me according to thy word.

The deacon receives the gospel book from the priest, exits the sanctuary and says:

DEACON: Wisdom. Stand upright. Let us hear the holy gospel.

PRIEST: Peace be to all.

CHOIR: And to thy spirit.

DEACON: The reading from the holy gospel according to *N*.

CHOIR: Glory to thee, O Lord. Glory to thee.

DEACON: Let us attend. *(and he chants the appointed lection)*

» **THE GOSPEL — see bulletin**

When the gospel is completed, the deacon enters the sanctuary, as the priest blesses him, saying quietly:

PRIEST: Peace be to thee that proclaimest the gospel.

The deacon gives the gospel book to the priest, who blesses the faithful with it as the choir chants:

CHOIR: Glory to thee, O Lord. Glory to thee.

*The priest places the gospel book upright before the tabernacle and preaches the homily. Then the deacon says **Help us, save us...** below. However, the priest may first offer the prayer for the catechumens aloud if there are any in the parish:*

PRAYER FOR THE CATECHUMENS

O Lord our God, who dwellest on high and regardest things below, who hast sent forth as the salvation of the race of men thine only-begotten Son and God, our Lord Jesus Christ: Look down upon thy servants the catechumens, who have bowed their necks before thee; make them worthy in due season of the laver of regeneration, the remission of sins and the robe of incorruption. Unite them to thy holy, catholic and apostolic Church, and number them with thine elect flock, that with us they may glorify thine all-honorable and majestic name, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

DEACON: Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace. Wisdom.

PRIEST: That guarded always by thy might we may ascribe glory unto thee, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

THE CHERUBIC HYMN

Let us, who mystically represent the cherubim and sing the thrice-holy hymn to the life-giving Trinity, now lay aside all earthly care, that we may receive the King of all, invisibly escorted by the angelic hosts. Alleluia. Alleluia. Alleluia.

As the choir chants the cherubic hymn, the priest quietly says the prayer of the cherubic hymn:

THE PRAYER OF THE CHERUBIC HYMN

PRIEST: No one who is bound with the desires and pleasures of the flesh is worthy to approach or to draw nigh or to serve thee, O King of glory ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

The priest and deacon say the cherubic hymn. The priest then censes the sanctuary, the icons on the iconostasis and the nave from the holy doors. As the priest censes, he recites Psalm 50 or other prayers, as determined by the liturgical day and season. The faithful bow without making the sign of the Cross as the priest censes them.

THE GREAT ENTRANCE

The priest, following the deacon for the great entrance, exits the sanctuary. As he exits, the deacon says:

DEACON: All of you, the Lord God remember in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

*After making the great entrance, the deacon immediately enters the sanctuary through the holy doors and stands at the holy table. The priest intones the following petitions while making the great entrance, with the choir responding **Amen** after each petition.*

PRIEST: Our father and metropolitan, N., (and our bishop, N.,) and all our brotherhood in Christ, the Lord God remember in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

Our president (or appropriate head of state), civil authorities and armed forces, the Lord God remember in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

The servants of God, NN., that they may have mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of sins, the Lord God remember in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

The servants of God departed this life in the hope of the resurrection and life eternal, NN., the Lord God remember in his kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

» NAMES OF THE LIVING AND THE DEPARTED — as commemorated at your parish

The priest enters the sanctuary while the choir concludes the cherubic hymn. He places the chalice and diskos on the antimension. After taking the aer from the deacon, he then places it over the gifts.

DEACON: Do good, master.

The priest censes the gifts thrice, saying the conclusion of Psalm 50. The deacon exits the sanctuary and intones the petitions of the litany of supplication, while the priest quietly says the prayer of the proskomedia.

THE LITANY OF SUPPLICATION

DEACON: Let us complete our prayer unto the Lord.

*The choir responds **Lord, have mercy** to each petition until noted.*

For the precious gifts now set forth, let us pray to the Lord.

For this holy house and those who with faith, reverence and fear of God enter therein, let us pray to the Lord.

For our deliverance from all tribulation, wrath, danger and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

That the whole day may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us ask of the Lord.

*The choir responds **Grant this, O Lord** to this and the following petitions.*

An angel of peace, a faithful guide, a guardian of our souls and bodies, let us ask of the Lord.

Pardon and remission of our sins and transgressions, let us ask of the Lord.

All things good and profitable for our souls and peace for the world, let us ask of the Lord.

That we may complete the remaining time of our life in peace and repentance, let us ask of the Lord.

A Christian ending to our life, painless, blameless, peaceful, and a good defense before the fearful judgment seat of Christ, let us ask.

Calling to remembrance our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary, with all the saints, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

THE PRAYER OF THE PROSKOMEDIA

PRIEST: O Lord God Almighty, who alone art holy, who dost accept a sacrifice of praise from those who call upon thee with their whole heart ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: Through the compassions of thine only-begotten Son, with whom thou art blessed, together with thine all-holy and good and life-giving Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

Turning to face the people, the priest blesses, saying:

PRIEST: Peace be to all.

CHOIR: And to thy spirit.

The priest turns and faces east while the deacon says:

DEACON: Let us love one another, that with one accord we may confess:

CHOIR: Father, Son and Holy Spirit: the Trinity, one in essence and undivided.

The priest makes three metanias before the holy table, saying:

PRIEST: I will love thee, O Lord, my Strength; the Lord is my firm Foundation, my Refuge and my Deliverer.

DEACON: The doors. The doors. In wisdom, let us attend.

THE SYMBOL OF FAITH (THE CREED)

ALL: I believe in one God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth and of all things visible and invisible,

And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, the only-begotten, begotten of the Father before all worlds,

Light of Light, Very God of Very God, begotten, not made, of one essence with the Father, by whom all things were made,

Who for us men and for our salvation came down from heaven and was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and the Virgin Mary and became man

And was crucified also for us under Pontius Pilate and suffered and was buried, and the third day He rose again, according to the Scriptures,

And ascended into heaven and sitteth at the right hand of the Father;

And he shall come again with glory to judge the living and the dead, whose kingdom shall have no end.

And I believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord and Giver of Life, who proceedeth from the Father,

Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified, who spake by the prophets;

And I believe in one holy catholic and apostolic Church.

I acknowledge one Baptism for the remission of sins.

I look for the resurrection of the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.

THE HOLY ANAPHORA

DEACON: Let us stand aright. Let us stand with fear. Let us attend that we may offer the holy oblation in peace.

CHOIR: A mercy of peace, a sacrifice of praise.

PRIEST: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God the Father and the communion of the Holy Spirit be with you all.

CHOIR: And with thy spirit.

Still facing west, the priest lifts up his arms, saying:

PRIEST: Let us lift up our hearts.

CHOIR: We lift them up unto the Lord.

Facing east and bowing low before the holy table, the priest says:

PRIEST: Let us give thanks unto the Lord.

CHOIR: It is meet and right.

*The choir either ends, as is our tradition, after **It is meet and right**, or continues with **to worship Father, Son and Holy Spirit: the Trinity, one in essence and undivided**, in which case the priest begins the prayer of the anaphora immediately, while the choir is singing.*

PRIEST: It is meet and right to hymn thee, to bless thee, to praise thee, to give thanks unto thee and to worship thee in every place of thy dominion; for thou art God ineffable, inconceivable, invisible, incomprehensible, ever-existing and eternally the same ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: Singing the triumphal hymn, shouting, proclaiming and saying:

CHOIR: Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord of Sabaoth, heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

As the choir chants, the priest continues:

PRIEST: With these blessed powers we also, O Master who lovest mankind, cry aloud and say: Holy art thou and all-holy, thou and thine only-begotten Son and thy Holy Spirit...

The priest continues, recounting the dispensation of salvation, and comes to the words of institution:

...in the night in which he was betrayed — or, rather, gave himself up for the life of the world — took bread in his holy and immaculate and blameless hands, and when he had given thanks and blessed it and hallowed it and broken it, he gave it to his holy disciples and apostles, saying:

PRIEST: Take, eat. This is my Body which is broken for you, for the remission of sins.

CHOIR: Amen.

PRIEST: And likewise after supper, he took the cup, saying:

PRIEST: Drink of this, all of you. This is my Blood of the new covenant, which is shed for you and for many, for the remission of sins.

CHOIR: Amen.

PRIEST: Having in remembrance, therefore, this saving commandment and all those things which have come to pass for us — the cross, the grave, the third-day resurrection, the ascension into heaven, the sitting at the right hand and the second and glorious coming —

PRIEST: Thine own of thine own we offer unto thee, in behalf of all and for all.

CHOIR: We hymn thee, we bless thee, we give thanks unto thee, O Lord, and we pray unto thee, O our God.

THE EPICLESIS

PRIEST: Again we offer unto thee this rational and bloodless worship and beseech thee and pray thee and supplicate thee: Send down thy Holy Spirit upon us and upon these gifts here spread forth,

DEACON: Bless, master, the holy bread.

The priest blesses the Lamb, saying:

PRIEST: And make this bread the precious Body of thy Christ,

DEACON: Amen.

DEACON: Bless, master, the holy cup.

The priest blesses the chalice, saying:

PRIEST: And that which is in this cup, the precious Blood of thy Christ,

DEACON: Amen.

DEACON: Bless both, master.

The priest makes one sign of the cross over both the diskos and chalice, saying:

PRIEST: Changing them by thy Holy Spirit,

DEACON: Amen. Amen. Amen. Remember me a sinner, holy master.

PRIEST: That, to those who shall partake thereof, they may be unto vigilance of soul, unto remission of sins, unto the communion of thy Holy Spirit, unto the fulfillment of the kingdom of heaven and unto boldness toward thee, not unto judgment nor unto condemnation.

And again we offer unto thee this rational worship for all those who in faith have gone before us to their rest: forefathers, fathers, patriarchs, prophets, apostles, preachers, evangelists, martyrs, confessors, ascetics and every

righteous spirit made perfect in faith,

Taking up the censer and censuring the gifts nine times, the priest says:

PRIEST: Especially our all-holy, immaculate, most blessed and glorious Lady, the Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary;

The deacon censes round about the holy table while the choir chants the appointed megalynarion. The usual one is given here:

CHOIR: It is truly meet to bless thee, O Theotokos, who art ever blessed and all-blameless and the Mother of our God. More honorable than the cherubim and more glorious beyond compare than the seraphim, thou who without corruption didst bear God the Word and art truly Theotokos: we magnify thee.

» **MEGALYNARION — replaced on feasts; see bulletin**

While censuring the southeast corner of the holy table, the deacon pauses and quietly reads the diptychs of the departed.

PRIEST: The holy Prophet, Forerunner and Baptist John; the holy, glorious and all-laudable apostles; *N. (saint of the day)*, whose memory we celebrate; and all thy saints, at whose supplications visit us, O God.

» **SAINT OF THE DAY — see bulletin**

And be mindful of all those who have fallen asleep before us in the hope of resurrection unto life eternal, *NN.*, and grant them rest, O our God, where the light of thy countenance watcheth over them.

And again we beseech thee: Be mindful, O Lord, of every bishop of the Orthodox, who rightly divideth the word of thy truth, of all the presbytery, the diaconate in Christ and every priestly and monastic order.

And again we offer unto thee this rational worship for the whole world, for the holy, catholic and apostolic Church, for those who live in chastity and lead a godly way of life, and for all civil authorities and our armed forces; grant them, O Lord, peaceful times that we, in their tranquility, may lead a calm and peaceful life in all reverence and godliness.

The priest continues aloud:

Among the first be mindful, O Lord, of our father and metropolitan, *N.*, (and our bishop, *N.*) whom do thou grant unto thy holy churches in peace, safety, honor, health and length of days and rightly dividing the word of thy truth.

The deacon faces the people and says:

DEACON: And of the people here present, of those whom they are remembering and of all mankind.

CHOIR: And of all mankind.

This exchange is omitted if no deacon is serving.

PRIEST: Be mindful, O Lord, of this city in which we dwell and of every city and countryside and of those who in faith dwell therein. Be mindful, O Lord, of those who travel by sea, by land and by air, the sick, the suffering, the captive and their salvation. Be mindful, O Lord, of those who bear fruit and do good works in thy holy churches and who remember the poor, and upon us all send forth thy mercies.

And grant us with one mouth and one heart to glorify and praise thine all-honorable and majestic name, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

The priest turns to face the west and blesses the people, saying:

PRIEST: And may the mercies of our great God and Saviour Jesus Christ be with you all.

CHOIR: And with thy spirit.

The priest returns to the holy table as the deacon stands before the holy doors and intones the following petitions.

THE LITANY BEFORE THE OUR FATHER

DEACON: Having commemorated all the saints, again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

*The choir responds **Lord, have mercy** to each petition.*

For the precious gifts which have been spread forth and sanctified, let us pray to the Lord.

That our God, who loveth mankind, having received them upon his holy, most heavenly and ideal altar as an aroma of spiritual sweetness, will send down upon us in return his divine grace and the gift of the Holy Spirit, let us pray.

Asking for the unity of the faith and the communion of the Holy Spirit, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

The deacon moves to stand before the icon of Christ, while the priest, having finished the prayer, says aloud the exclamation.

PRIEST: Unto thee we commend our whole life and our hope, O Master who lovest mankind, and we beseech thee and pray thee and supplicate thee: Vouchsafe us to partake of thy heavenly and dread mysteries of this sacred and spiritual table with a pure conscience, unto remission of sins, unto pardon of transgressions, unto communion of the Holy Spirit, unto inheritance of the kingdom of heaven, unto boldness toward thee, and not unto judgment nor unto condemnation.

And vouchsafe, O Master, that with boldness and without condemnation we may dare to call upon thee, the heavenly God, as Father and to say:

THE OUR FATHER

ALL: Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come; thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

PRIEST: For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

Turning to face the west, the priest blesses the people, saying:

PRIEST: Peace be to all.

CHOIR: And to thy spirit.

The priest faces east and reads the following prayer as the deacon says:

DEACON: Bow your heads unto the Lord.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

PRIEST: We give thanks unto thee, O King invisible, who by thy boundless power hast made all things and in the multitude of thy mercy hast brought all things from nothingness into being ...

The priest continues this prayer quietly; only the concluding exclamation below is said aloud.

PRIEST: Through the grace and compassions and love toward mankind of thine only-begotten Son, with whom thou art blessed, together with thine all-holy and good and life-giving Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

The priest quietly prays:

PRIEST: Hear us, O Lord Jesus Christ our God, from thy holy dwelling-place and from the throne of glory of thy kingdom; and come to sanctify us, O thou who sittest on high with the Father and art here invisibly present with us; and vouchsafe by thy mighty hand to impart unto us thine immaculate Body and precious Blood, and through us unto all the people.

THE ELEVATION AND FRACTION

DEACON: Let us attend.

The priest takes up the Lamb in both hands and slightly elevates it over the diskos, saying:

PRIEST: The Holy Things are for the holy.

CHOIR: One is holy, One is Lord, Jesus Christ, to the glory of God the Father. Amen.

*While the choir chants **One is holy...**, the deacon enters the sanctuary through the south door and, standing at his place at the holy table, says to the priest:*

DEACON: Divide, master, the holy bread.

The priest divides the Lamb into four parts with great reverence and care, saying:

PRIEST: Divided and distributed is the Lamb of God, who is divided yet not disunited, who is ever eaten yet never consumed but sanctifieth those who partake thereof.

*The priest arranges the pieces of the Lamb on the rim of the diskos in the form of a cross: **IC** at the top (placed in the chalice); **NI** and **KA** at either side (for the people); **XC** at the bottom (for the clergy).*

DEACON: Fill, master, the holy cup.

*The priest takes the portion sealed **IC** and makes therewith the sign of the cross over the top of the chalice and places it in the chalice, saying:*

PRIEST: The fullness of the Holy Spirit.

DEACON: Amen.

Bringing for the priest's blessing the warm water in the zeon, the deacon says:

DEACON: Bless, master, the zeon.

Blessing the warm water, the priest says:

PRIEST: Blessed is the warmth of thy holy things, O Lord, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

DEACON: Amen.

The deacon then pours a sufficient quantity of warm water into the chalice crosswise, while saying:

DEACON: The warmth of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

THE PRE-COMMUNION PRAYERS

ALL: I believe, O Lord, and I confess that thou art truly the Christ, the Son of the living God, who didst come into the world to save sinners, of whom I am first. And I believe that this is truly thine own immaculate Body and that this is truly thine own precious Blood. Wherefore, I pray thee, have mercy upon me, and pardon my transgressions

both voluntary and involuntary, of word and of deed, of knowledge and of ignorance; and make me worthy to partake without condemnation of thine immaculate mysteries unto remission of sins and unto life everlasting. Amen.

Of thy mystic supper, O Son of God, accept me today as a communicant; for I will not speak of thy mystery to thine enemies, neither will I give thee a kiss as did Judas, but like the thief will I confess thee: Remember me, O Lord, in thy kingdom.

Not unto judgment nor unto condemnation be my partaking of thy holy mysteries, O Lord, but unto the healing of soul and body.

Further pre-communion prayers and other troparia are found elsewhere in the service book and in the pew book.

The choir then sings the appointed communion hymn. The usual one for Sundays is given here:

CHOIR: Praise the Lord from the heavens. Praise him in the highest. Alleluia.

» **COMMUNION HYMN — varies on feasts; see bulletin**

THE COMMUNION

The clergy commune. Then with great reverence and care, the deacon breaks into small pieces the portions of the Lamb sealed NI and KA and places them in the chalice. The priest covers the chalice with the kalima and hands the chalice and spoon to the deacon. Standing in the holy doors, the deacon elevates the chalice, facing the people, and says:

DEACON: With fear of God and faith and love, draw near.

The priest and deacon exit the sanctuary through the holy doors as the choir chants:

CHOIR: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord. God is the Lord and hath appeared unto us.

The priest then communes those who are prepared to receive the holy mysteries. The faithful remain standing out of reverence for the Body and Blood of Christ. When all have been communed, the priest covers the chalice, hands it to the deacon and then blesses the people, saying:

PRIEST: O God, save thy people and bless thine inheritance.

*The choir chants **We have seen the true Light...** or its appointed replacement:*

CHOIR: We have seen the true Light; we have received the heavenly Spirit; We have found the true Faith, worshipping the undivided Trinity; for He hath saved us.

» **REPLACEMENT FOR "WE HAVE SEEN THE TRUE LIGHT" — on certain feasts and in the paschal season; see bulletin**

The priest and deacon enter the sanctuary through the holy doors, and the priest places the chalice on the antimension. The deacon carefully wipes the remaining particles into the chalice, saying:

DEACON: By thy precious Blood, O Lord, wash away the sins of thy servants here commemorated, through the intercessions of all thy saints.

The deacon then says:

DEACON: Exalt, master.

The priest takes up the censer and censes the chalice thrice, saying:

PRIEST: Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens, and thy glory, above all the earth.

The priest gives up the censer and then gives the diskos to the deacon, who carries it to and places it upon the prothesis. The priest lifts the chalice and, turning to face the people, continues, saying aloud:

PRIEST: Always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen. Let our mouths be filled with thy praise, O Lord, that we may sing of thy glory; for thou hast permitted us to partake of thy holy, divine, immortal and life-giving mysteries. Establish us in thy sanctification that all the day long we may meditate upon thy righteousness. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

The priest carries the chalice to the prothesis and, placing it there, censes it. The deacon exits the sanctuary and says the litany of thanksgiving, while the priest says the prayer of thanksgiving quietly:

LITANY OF THANKSGIVING

DEACON: Stand upright. Having partaken of the divine, holy, immaculate, immortal, heavenly, life-giving and dread mysteries of Christ, let us worthily give thanks unto the Lord.

The choir responds Lord, have mercy to each petition.

Help us; save us; have mercy on us; and keep us, O God, by thy grace.

Asking that the whole day may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us commend ourselves and each other and all our life unto Christ our God.

CHOIR: To thee, O Lord.

THE PRAYER OF THANKSGIVING

PRIEST: We give thanks unto thee, O Master who lovest mankind, Benefactor of our souls, for that thou hast vouchsafed this day to feed us with thy heavenly and immortal mysteries. Make straight our path; establish us all in thy fear; guard our steps, through the prayers of the glorious Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary and of all thy saints.

During the following exclamation, the priest lifts the gospel book, makes the sign of the cross with it over the folded antimension and lays it upon the antimension.

PRIEST: For thou art our Sanctification, and unto thee we ascribe glory, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

The priest exits the sanctuary through the holy doors, saying:

PRIEST: Let us go forth in peace.

CHOIR: In the name of the Lord.

The deacon, having moved to stand before the icon of Christ, lifts his orarion and says:

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord.

CHOIR: Lord, have mercy.

Standing before the icon of Christ on the iconostasis, the priest says the prayer behind the amvon.

THE PRAYER BEHIND THE AMVON

PRIEST: O Lord, who blestest those who bless thee and sanctifiest those who put their trust in thee: Save thy people, and bless thine inheritance, preserve the fullness of thy Church, sanctify those who love the beauty of thy house, glorify them in recompense by thy divine power, and forsake us not who hope on thee. Give peace to thy world, to thy churches, to the priests, to the civil authorities, to the armed forces and to all thy people; for all good giving and every perfect gift is from above and cometh down from thee, the Father of lights, and unto thee we ascribe glory, thanksgiving and worship, to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

Blessed be the name of the Lord henceforth and forevermore. (*thrice*)

The priest and the deacon enter the sanctuary and go directly to the prothesis. Standing before the prothesis, the priest says:

THE PRAYER AT THE CONSUMPTION OF THE HOLY GIFTS

PRIEST: O Christ our God, who art thyself the Fulfillment of the Law and the Prophets, who didst fulfill all the dispensation of the Father: Fill our hearts with joy and gladness, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

After the prayer, the priest blesses the deacon to consume the remaining holy gifts. If there is a special service — for example, Trisagion Prayers of Mercy for the Departed, Removal of Marriage Crowns, or a procession — it takes place at this time. Afterward the deacon says:

DEACON: Let us pray to the Lord.

CHOIR: Lord, have mercy.

The priest turns to face the people and blesses them, saying:

PRIEST: The blessing of the Lord and his mercy come upon you, through his divine grace and love toward mankind, always, now and ever, and unto ages of ages.

CHOIR: Amen.

The priest turns toward the icon of Christ and says:

PRIEST: Glory to thee, O Christ our God and our Hope, glory to thee.

CHOIR: Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.
Lord, have mercy. (*thrice*) Father, bless.

Standing in the holy doors, facing west, the priest says the dismissal, blessing the people as he concludes:

THE DISMISSAL

PRIEST: May (*insert the appointed characteristic phrase*) Christ our true God, through the intercessions of his all-immaculate and all-blameless holy Mother; by the might of the precious and life-giving cross; by the protection of the honorable bodiless powers of heaven; at the supplications of the honorable, glorious Prophet, Forerunner and Baptist John; of the holy, glorious and all-laudable apostles; of our father among the saints John Chrysostom, archbishop of Constantinople; of the holy, glorious and right victorious martyrs; of our venerable and God-bearing fathers; of *N. (patron saint of the church)*; of the holy and righteous ancestors of God, Joachim and Anna; of *N. (the saint of the day)*, whose memory we celebrate; and of all the saints, have mercy on us and save us, forasmuch as he is good and loveth mankind.

» CHARACTERISTIC PHRASE (varies by feast) and SAINT OF THE DAY — see bulletin

Then facing the icon of Christ, the priest says, while crossing himself:

PRIEST: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us and save us.

CHOIR: Amen.